

Week 8 Report

3D Printer Production Simulator

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1 System Architecture

The completed system consists of three independent services: provider, manufacturer, and retailer, plus a turn engine that orchestrates them through simulated time. Each service owns its own SQLite database and its own day counter. No service reads another's database. All cross-service communication goes through HTTP/JSON over documented REST contracts.

The full system architecture diagram is shown in Appendix A.

1.1 Turn Engine: Order of Operations

Each simulated day runs in five phases:

1. **Signal injection.** The engine reads the active scenario event for the current day and applies the `supply_modifier` and `lead_time_modifier` to the provider's stock replenishment settings.
2. **Demand injection.** The engine generates synthetic customer orders from a Gaussian distribution scaled by `demand_modifier` and `base_demand`, then posts them to the retailer's `/api/orders` endpoint. The demand formula is `round(N(mean × demand_modifier, variance))` orders placed.
3. **Agent turns (sequential).** Each agent receives a pre-fetched state snapshot and a copy of the active market signal in its prompt. Execution order is **retailer → manufacturer → provider**. The retailer acts first because it places sales orders on the manufacturer; the manufacturer's state is re-fetched after the retailer turn so it sees those orders before it decides. The provider acts last because its stock levels do not affect manufacturer decisions within the same tick.
4. **Day advance.** All three apps advance their internal day counters in the same order: retailer → manufacturer → provider. The manufacturer's advance polls every pending external purchase order against the provider and delivers inventory when the provider reports `DELIVERED`.
5. **Metrics snapshot.** The engine queries each app's REST surface and appends a JSON line to `logs/metrics.jsonl` capturing stock, prices, order counts, and financials for that day.

1.2 Flow of Market Signals

The scenario file defines events with start/end days and multipliers. When multiple events overlap on the same day, the engine merges their modifiers using the following rules: `demand_modifier` values are multiplied together, while `supply_modifier` and `lead_time_modifier` take the lowest value across all active events, representing the most constrained condition. The merged signal is:

- **Passed verbatim in the agent prompt.** Each skill file receives the signal as structured text: `demand_modifier`, `supply_modifier`, `active_events`, and `event_descriptions`. The agent is expected to read this and adjust its decisions accordingly ordering more, raising prices, holding stock etc.
- **Applied by the engine to provider behaviour.** `supply_modifier` scales the provider's effective restocking. `lead_time_modifier` is shown in the provider's prompt to help the provider agent reason about longer lead times.
- **Applied to demand generation.** `demand_modifier` scales the Gaussian mean before injecting customer orders.

The signal is a hint, not a constraint. Agents may ignore it, act on it, or misread it.

1.3 Web UI: Manufacturer Dashboard

The manufacturer exposes a React + Vite dashboard at `http://localhost:3000` that gives a human operator full visibility into the simulation state without touching the CLI or the database directly.

- **Orders:** lists all incoming sales orders from the retailer with their status (PENDING, IN_PROGRESS, SHIPPED, DELIVERED). The operator can see at a glance how many orders are queued and whether the production pipeline is moving.

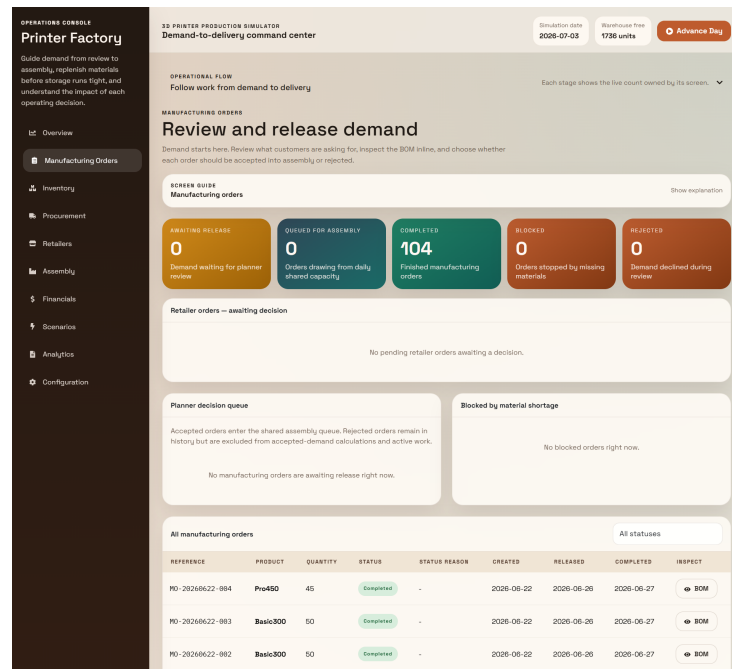


Figure 1: Orders page

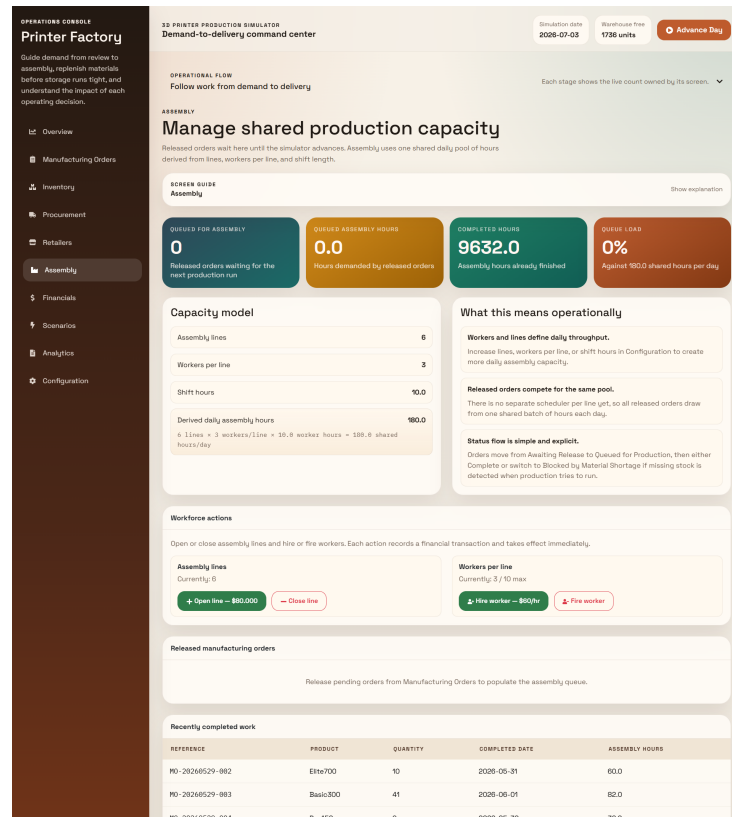


Figure 2: Production page

- **Production:** shows the assembly queue: active manufacturing orders, queued assembly hours, daily capacity, and the number of workers and lines.

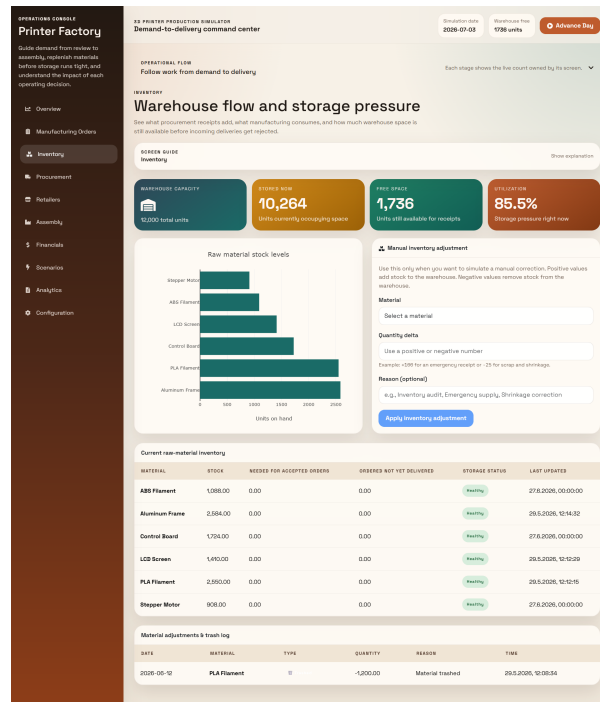


Figure 3: Inventory page

- **Inventory:** displays current stock for all six raw materials alongside their floor targets and the “trashable” surplus. Colour-coded status flags (CRITICAL, FLOOR, EXCESS) mirror the flags the agent reads from the CLI.

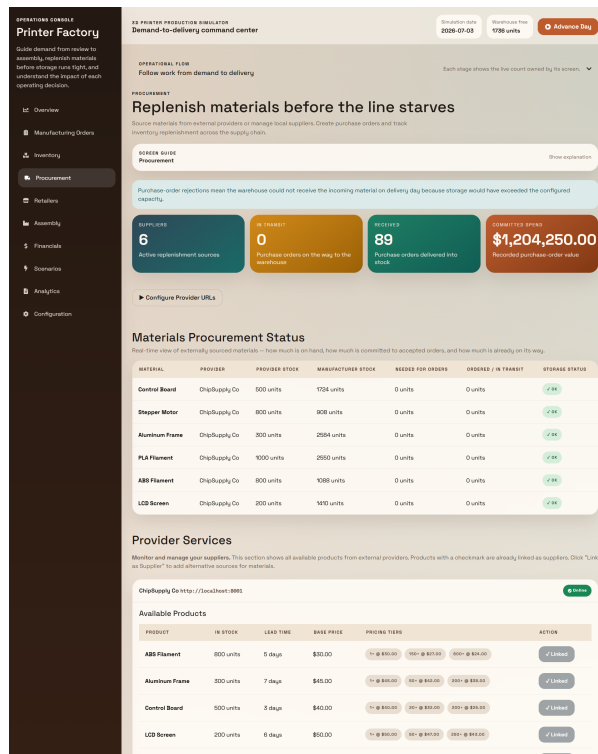


Figure 4: Suppliers page

- **Suppliers:** lists all six suppliers with their lead times and external provider wiring. Shows pending purchase orders in transit and their delivery days.

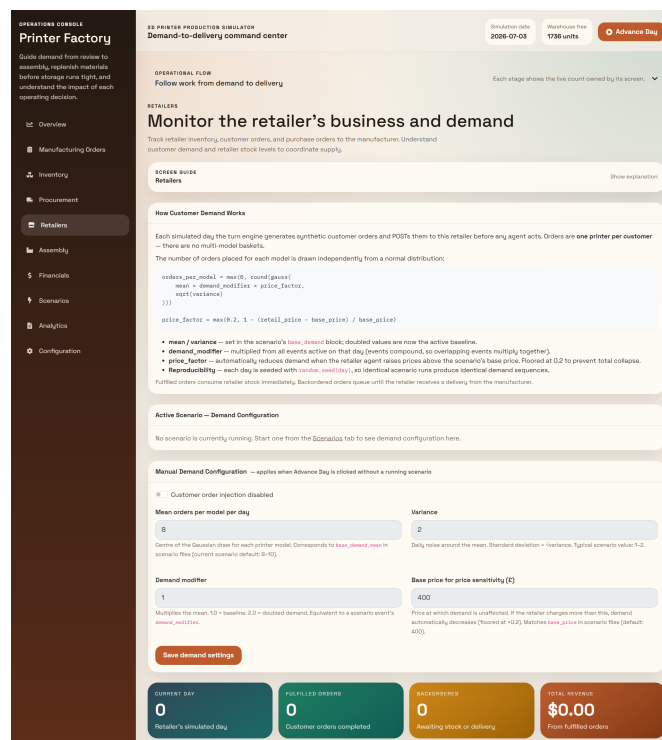


Figure 5: Retailers page

- **Retailers:** shows the connected retailer (PrinterWorld), the sales orders it has placed, and delivery status. This is the manufacturer's view of its downstream customer.

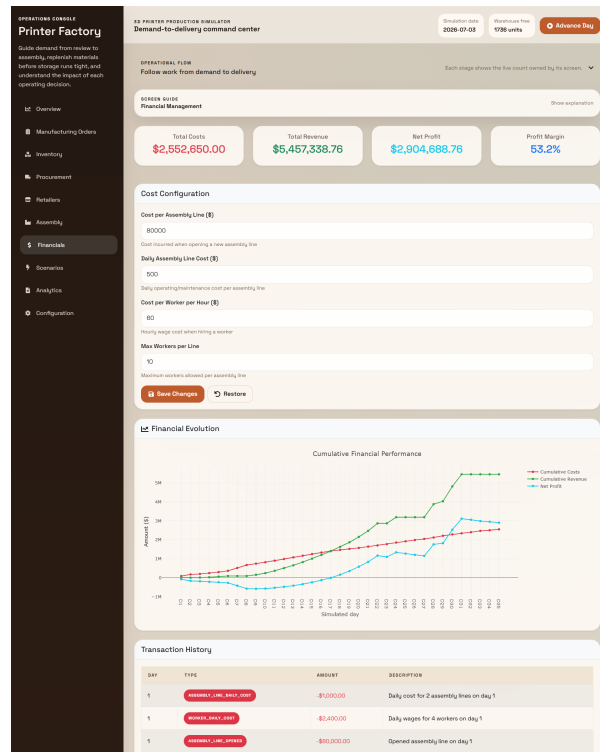


Figure 6: Financials page

- **Financials:** running totals for revenue, material costs, labour costs, and net profit. Updated each simulated day so the operator can track whether the agent's pricing decisions are generating margin.

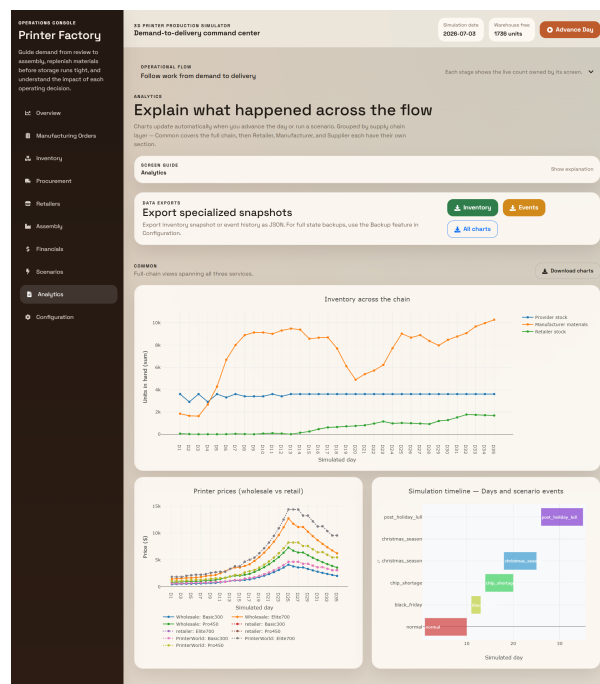


Figure 7: Reports page

- **Reports:** per-day event log and summary statistics. The event table is the audit trail: every state transition (order released, delivery received, price changed) is recorded here.

OPERATIONS CONSOLE
Printer Factory
Scale demand from retail to assembly, material materials before storage runs tight, and understand the impact of your operating decision.

1x PRINTER PRODUCTION SIMULATOR
Demand-to-delivery command center

Simulation date: 2026-07-03 | Warehouse free: 1736 units | [Advance Day](#)

OPERATIONAL FLOW
Follow work from demand to delivery

Each stage shows the live count owned by its screen.

SCENARIOS
Run autonomous scenarios
Pick a config (default agents are active) and a scenario (default market wants five on which day?), then watch the three apps respond in real time. Every run streams to [logs](#) on disk and to the panels below.

SCREEN GUIDE
Scenario Runner [Show explanation](#)

LAUNCH & RUN
Configuration
Combine one config with one scenario and choose how many days to simulate (0-40).

[Start scenario](#) [Stop](#) [Refresh](#) [Download logs](#) [Clear logs!](#)

Pick a config

sim-stub.json → stub agents
Manufacturer: Factory
Retailers: PrinterWorld
Providers: ChipSupply Co
Drivers (Claude skills): No (this agent)

Pick a scenario

smoke-test.json → smoke-test
Days to simulate: 5
normal (steady state) Only 5-10

Choose model & config

Agent model
Claude Haiku 4.5
Fast and cool effective

☒ **Enable extended thinking**
Extended thinking disabled → faster execution

☒ **Fast mode (optional agents)**
Fast mode (OFF → Claude LLM agents make real decisions (slow, uses API tokens))

☒ **Parallel agents**
Parallel (OFF → agents run sequentially, slower → manufacturer → provider (correct cost pricing, manufacturer now makes orders ahead of time))

Selected model
Claude-haiku-4-5-20251005

Provider
Anthropic Claude

Thinking mode
Disabled

Fast mode
OFF → LLM agents

Agent execution
Sequential (retailer → mfr → provider)

Scenario recommendations
This scenario recommends specific assembly and cost configuration. Click apply to use these values, or continue with current settings.

Assembly Capacity
Current: 0 lines → 5 workers × 120
Recommended: 120 lines

[Apply recommended](#)

Costs
Current: \$80000 (line opening, \$8000 line daily, \$800/hr, max \$1000)
Recommended: \$100000 (line opening, \$10000 line daily, \$800/hr, max \$1000)

[Apply recommended](#)

Figure 8: Scenarios page

- **Scenarios:** the UI launcher for the turn engine. Lets the operator select a config and scenario file, start or stop a multi-day run, and tail the per-turn agent logs in the browser without opening a terminal.

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Printer Factory
Scale demand from retail to assembly, material materials before storage runs tight, and understand the impact of your operating decision.

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Demand-to-delivery command center

Simulation date: 2026-07-03 | Warehouse free: 1736 units | [Advance Day](#)

OPERATIONAL FLOW
Follow work from demand to delivery

Each stage shows the live count owned by its screen.

SCENARIOS
Define how the factory works
Get scenario file, agent, manually defined, define shared assembly capacity, and maintain the product and material master data that drives the simulation.

SCREEN GUIDE
Configuration [Show explanation](#)

Simulation parameters

Warehouse capacity: 10000 Total storage units available for new material inventory.	Assembly lines: 5 Parallel lines contributing to the shared capacity pool.
Workers per line: 3 Operators available on each line during a shift.	Shift hours: 10 Hours worked per day by each worker.
Internal demand mean: 5 Average Manufacturer orders generated internally per day (Stochastic mode only).	Internal demand variance: 2 How much internal daily demand fluctuates around the mean.
Internal demand generator: Steady Generates random Manufacturer orders directly inside the manufacturer each day. (On-demand mode: 3 workers, 10 hours, 1000 units → demand enters through the retailer instead. Your agent customer apps appear into the retailer or retail orders, visit the Retailers page.)	Cost per assembly line (\$): 80000 Fixed cost incurred when opening a new assembly line.
Daily assembly line cost (\$): 500 Daily opening/maintenance cost per assembly line.	Cost per worker per hour (\$): 80 Hourly wage cost when hiring a worker.
Max workers per line: 10 Maximum workers allowed per assembly line.	
Derived daily assembly hours: 980.0 3 lines × 3 workers/line × 10.8 workers/hour × 100.0 shared hours/day The legacy daily assembly hours value is still exposed for compatibility, but this workforce model is now the primary way to manage capacity.	

Manufacturing status
Awaiting Release: demand exists but has not entered assembly.
Queued for Production: order is released and waiting to consume shared capacity.
Awaiting Release but Blocked by Material Shortage: the planner tried to release the order, but materials were missing immediately.
Queued for Production but Blocked by Material Shortage: the order had already been accepted, but production later detected a shortage.
Completed work finished on a simulation day.
Rejected planner declined the order without deleting its history.

Purchase order statuses
In Transit: supplier has been issued the PO and delivery is pending.
Received: the warehouse had enough space and inventory was increased.
Rejected: warehouse receipt would have exceeded capacity on delivery day.

[Save configuration](#) [Restore current values](#)

Reset options
[Reset to default config](#)
Restores the standard demo scenario:
• Resets 3 expanded printers (Bau005, Pua005, Cba005)
• Resets 5 materials and suppliers
• Resets completely all of materials

[Next](#)

Figure 9: Settings page

- **Settings:** simulation configuration: warehouse capacity, assembly line costs, worker wage rates, and the internal demand generator toggle. Changes here take effect on the next simulated day.

1.4 Data Models

1.4.1 Provider

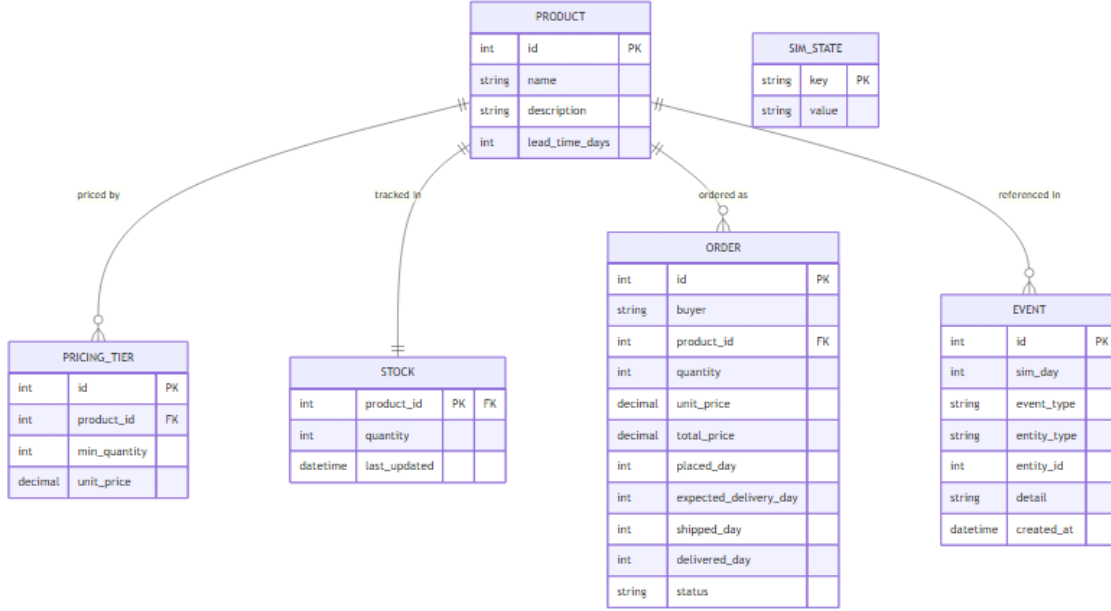


Figure 10: Provider data model. Order lifecycle: PENDING → CONFIRMED → IN_PROGRESS → SHIPPED → DELIVERED, with terminal states REJECTED (insufficient stock) and CANCELLED.

When an order is placed, the stock is immediately locked so the same units cannot be sold twice. The lock happens at the moment of ordering, not at the moment the buyer receives the goods. Every time an order moves from one state to the next, a record is written to the event log in the same operation, so the audit trail can never be out of sync with the order state.

1.4.2 Manufacturer

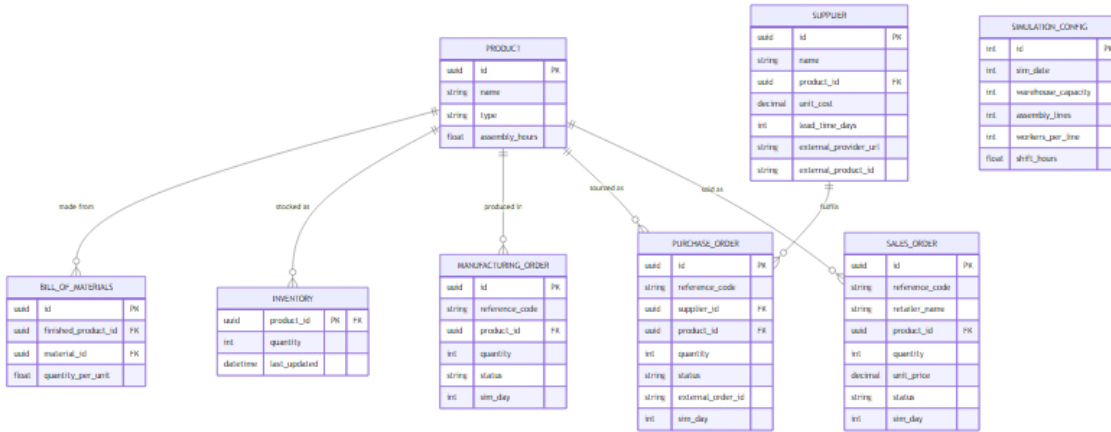


Figure 11: Manufacturer data model

The **Supplier** table gained **external_provider_url** and **external_product_id** in Week 6. When both are set, the manufacturer posts purchase orders to the provider's REST API instead of fulfilling them internally. **PurchaseOrder.external_order_id** stores the provider-assigned ID for polling.

1.4.3 Retailer

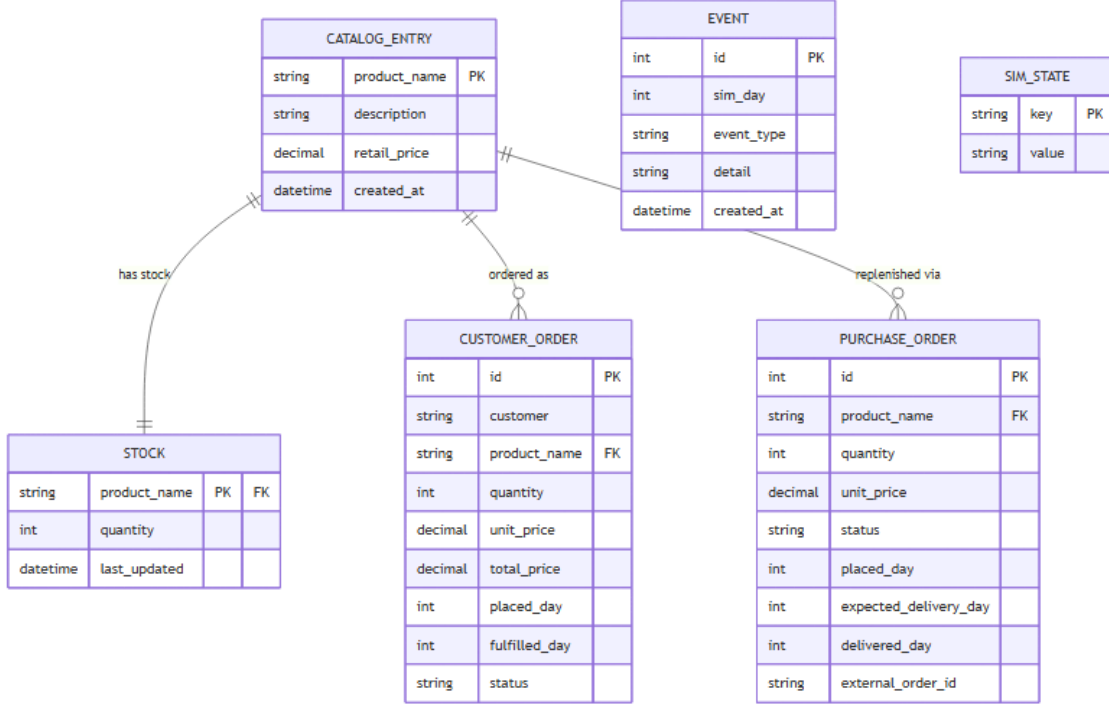


Figure 12: Retailer data model

The retailer keys its catalog by model name string, instead of a shared ID, since it does not share the manufacturer's product table, this means that cross-app identity travels as text over HTTP.

2 Agent Design

Three skill files define the role each Claude Code agent plays. Each is a markdown document passed as a system prompt before the agent's daily state snapshot.

2.1 Manufacturer Manager

The manufacturer agent is the most complex of the three. It manages six raw materials with different lead times (2–6 days), three assembly lines with configurable workers, and three finished-product price points. Its decision framework runs in one pass: assess capacity backlog, order materials by priority (CRITICAL/FLOOR first, safety stock second), release pending sales orders, adjust wholesale prices, and scale workers if queue pressure warrants it.

The key mechanism is the **proactive ordering strategy**: rather than waiting for stock to hit zero, the agent is instructed to order whenever a material is below its floor (30% of warehouse capacity divided by number of materials). High-lead-time materials (Aluminum Frame at 6 days, LCD Screen at 5 days) are ordered at provider maximum every day they are CRITICAL or LOW, regardless of how much is already in the pipeline.

- **What the agent is good at:** batching CLI commands, reading capacity metrics, and following the tiered ordering logic when given clear status flags. Capacity scaling is rapid: the agent expanded from 2 lines and 2 workers on day 1 to 6 lines and 10 workers by day 9, reacting to the early backlog fast enough to be fully scaled before Black Friday arrived on day 11.

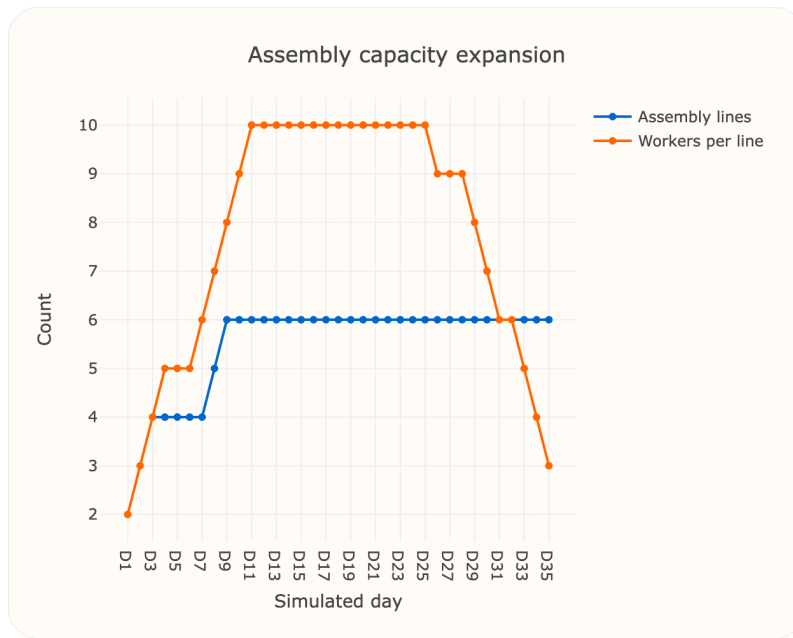


Figure 13: Number of assembly lines and workers per line across the 35-day run

The total capacity chart (Figure 13) shows the escalation effect: daily assembly hours grew from 40h (day 1) to 600h (days 11–25), a $15\times$ increase driven by both adding lines and adding workers per line simultaneously. This compounding meant capacity grew much faster than either lever alone would have produced.

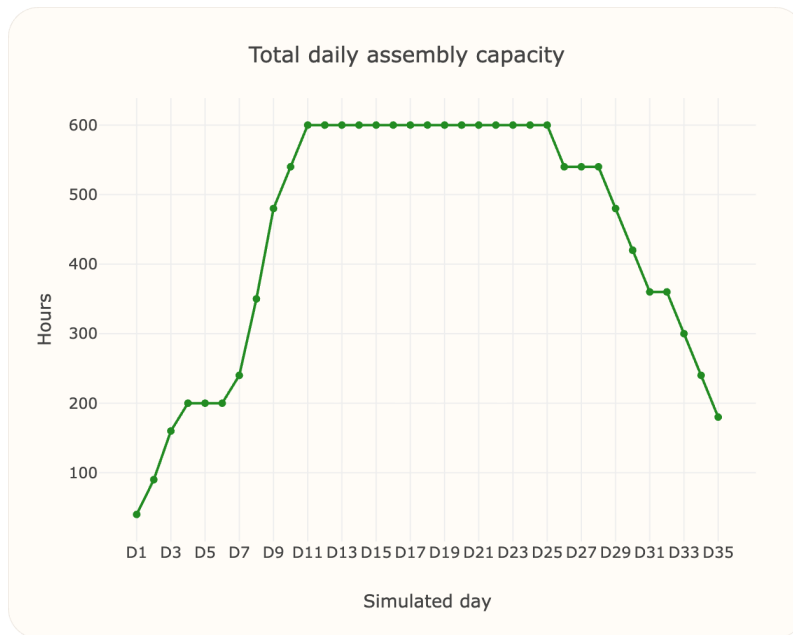


Figure 14: Total daily assembly hours (lines $\times$ workers $\times$ shift hours)

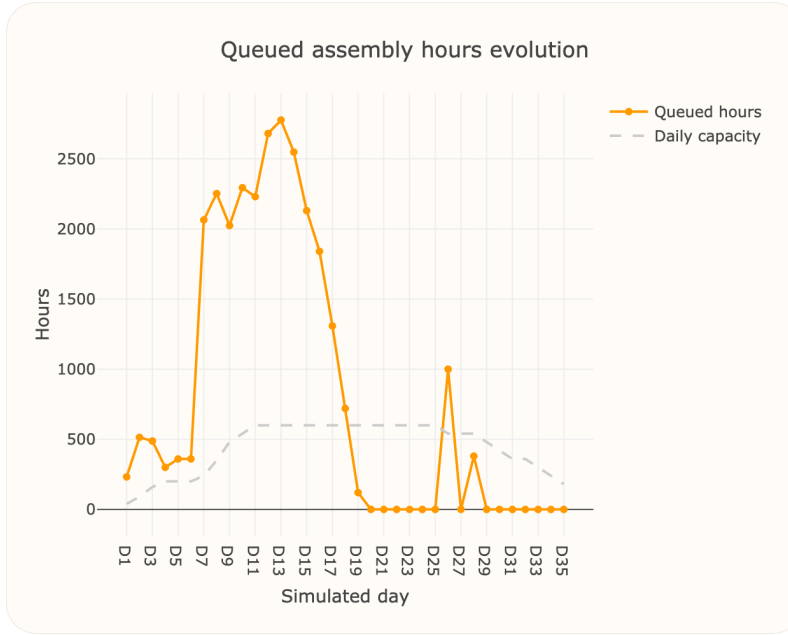


Figure 15: Hours of work queued at the assembly stage each day

The queued hours chart (Figure 15) shows the factory was under sustained load until day 13 (the end of Black Friday) after which the queue drained steadily, reaching zero by day 20.

- **What the agent is bad at:** The clearest failure was not closing assembly lines after demand collapsed on day 26, the agent only reduced workers per line (from 10 down to 3 by day 35), leaving all 6 lines open and paying fixed costs throughout. It did correctly stop releasing new production orders from day 26 onwards (the retailer already had 493+ printers against ~10 orders/day) and fulfilled 100% of customer orders through to day 35, but the idle assembly lines kept burning fixed costs with no output.
- **Skill rewrites:** The PRD-week7 proposed a six-section skeleton. The final file kept that structure and added the following through iterative refinement:
 1. **Release PENDING orders first:** Added after the agent logged *“The assembly queue is empty (0.0h), so no production release is possible”* and sat idle for two days with 34+ PENDING orders. Step 0 is placed before all other steps so the empty-queue signal cannot create a blocker before any analysis. Three DO NOT rules were added alongside it: do not treat 0.0h queued as a blocker, do not use Needed = 0 as a reason to skip releasing, do not treat the stock floor as a release gate.
 2. **Three-tier ordering system:** The original “order when below 50% of starting” rule was replaced with a tiered structure: Tier 0 = never order EXCESS materials; Tier 1 = order provider max every day for CRITICAL/LOW materials regardless of pipeline size; Tier 2 = demand-weighted safety stock when warehouse has room. This fixed chronic under-ordering of long-lead-time materials during demand surges.
 3. **Warehouse deadlock detection:** The `inventory-trash` emergency command and a full deadlock detection workflow were added after runs where incoming purchase orders were rejected because the warehouse was full, which blocked the materials that were needed to release the queued production orders. The skill now checks whether `current_usage + pending_arriving_today > warehouse_capacity` and guides the agent to trash surplus materials before the delivery arrives.
 4. **Assembly line scaling table:** A table mapping `backlog_days` and `demand_modifier` to hire/fire/open/close decisions replaced the vague “scale if busy” guidance. An ROI check was added before any hire or open call.

2.2 Provider Manager (skills/provider-manager.md)

The provider agent manages six raw material lines for ChipSupply Co. Its job each day is to restock products below 50% of their starting level, raise prices when stock is below 30% of starting, lower prices when stock is above 150%, and stay within a 15% daily price change bound. It receives the same market signal as the other agents and is expected to restock more aggressively when `demand_modifier > 1.5`.

- **What the agent is good at:** the restocking decisions are straightforward, the starting stock targets are explicit in the skill, so the agent reliably ordered when stock dropped. Most importantly, the agent kept all component stocks topped up throughout the entire run, including during the chip shortage (days 14–20), so no material ever ran out. Because stock never fell below the 30% threshold that triggers a price increase, bulk prices correctly stayed flat: Control Board held at \$25 for all 35 days, consistent with its rules.

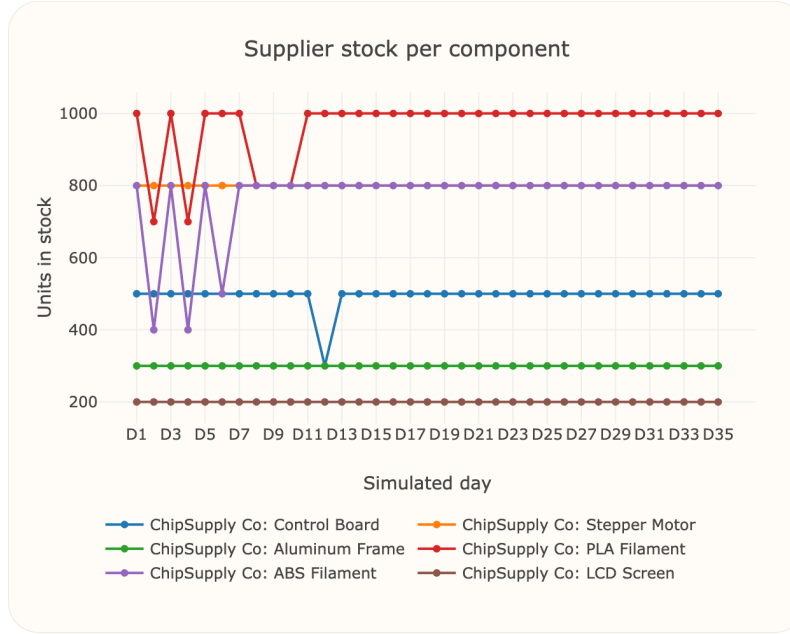


Figure 16: Supplier stock per component

- **What the agent is bad at:** Aluminum Frame and ABS Filament showed erratic price oscillations (roughly \$22–\$38 and \$11–\$24 respectively) that were not clearly tied to stock levels or scenario events, prices moved up and down without a sustained trend in either direction. This suggests the agent was reacting to small day-to-day stock fluctuations rather than following a consistent pricing strategy.

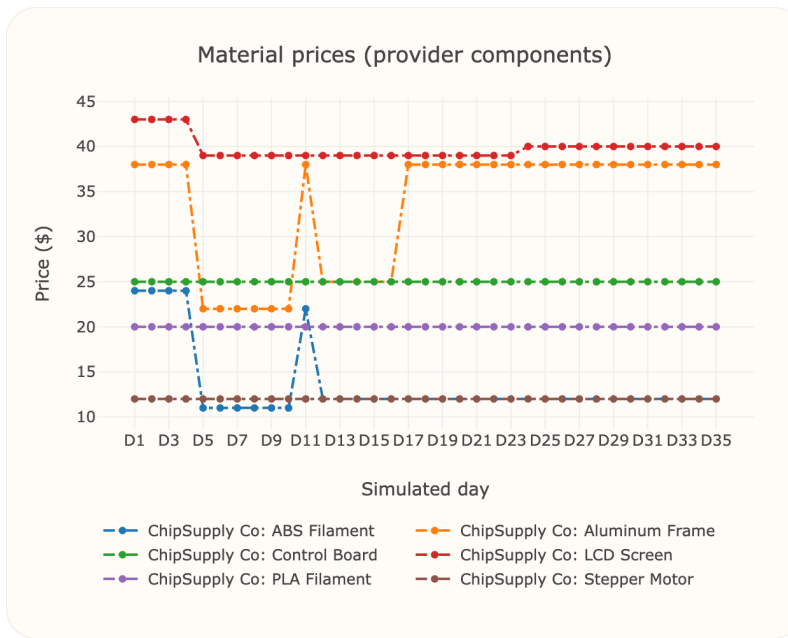


Figure 17: Material prices (provider components)

- **Skill rewrites:** The week8 brief proposed a minimal five-section template. Key changes applied:
 1. **Starting Stock Reference table added:** explicit target quantities per product (Control Board: 500, Stepper Motor: 800, Aluminum Frame: 300, etc.) so the agent has a stable reorder target without calling catalog each day.
 2. **Restock triggers expanded:** the original “restock if below 50% of starting level” rule was extended with two new conditions: restock earlier when `lead_time_modifier > 1.0` (treating 75% of target as the reorder point because replenishment will arrive slower), and restock conservatively when `supply_modifier < 0.7` (prioritise products tied to pending orders rather than blanket refills).
 3. **“No price cuts while orders are pending” rule added:** the original DO NOT only said no >15% change in one day and no zero stock. A third rule was added to prevent the agent from lowering prices during scarcity while accepted orders were still in progress.
 4. **lead_time_modifier added to Market Signals:** the proposed template only covered `supply_modifier < 0.7` and `demand_modifier > 1.5`. The current file adds a steady-state band (`0.8–1.2 = no action`) and `lead_time_modifier > 1.0` as a restock trigger.

2.3 Retail Manager

The retail agent manages PrinterWorld. Each day it fulfills or backorders pending customer orders, places replenishment orders with the manufacturer when stock drops below safety thresholds (Basic300: 30 units, Pro450: 15 units, Elite700: 5 units), and adjusts retail prices 5% up or down based on stock pressure and the active demand signal.

- **What the agent is good at:** fulfillment and backordering logic was consistent and no customer orders were left in PENDING state at end of day. The safety stock floor kept replenishment orders arriving even during quieter periods. On Black Friday (days 11–13) the retailer fulfilled 82/96/104 orders per day while accumulating 63/59/62 backorders, but the proportion of fulfilled vs backordered was similar to the pre-surge baseline, in other words, the agent did not perform noticeably worse under $3\times$ demand than it had during normal days.
- **What the agent is bad at:** After day 26, when the post-holiday lull cut demand to ~ 10 orders/day, rather than cutting prices to clear inventory, the retailer’s stock for Basic300 and Pro450 kept growing (reaching 840 units by day 35) while retail price fell only slowly from 4,614 to 3,057 — still well above what was needed to stimulate demand at the new lower level.

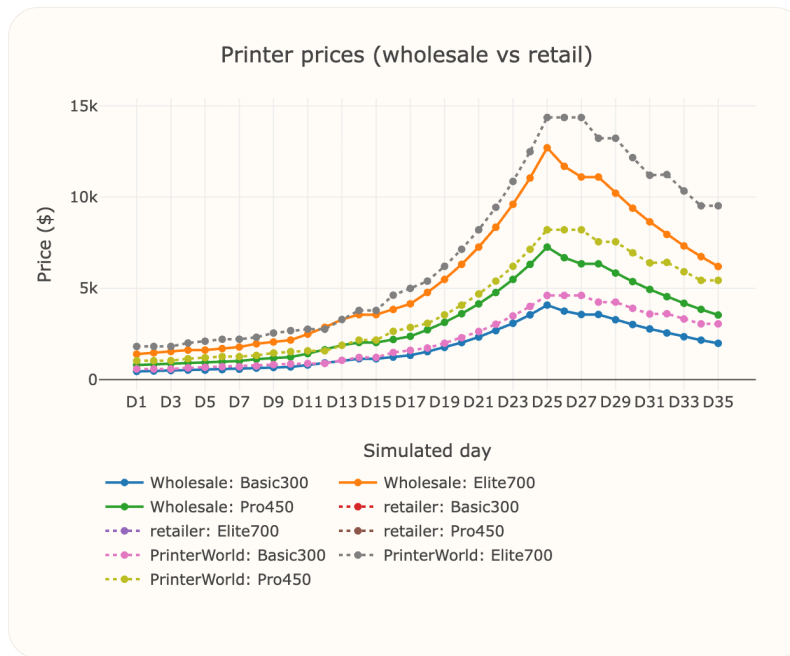


Figure 18: Basic300 wholesale and retail price per simulated day

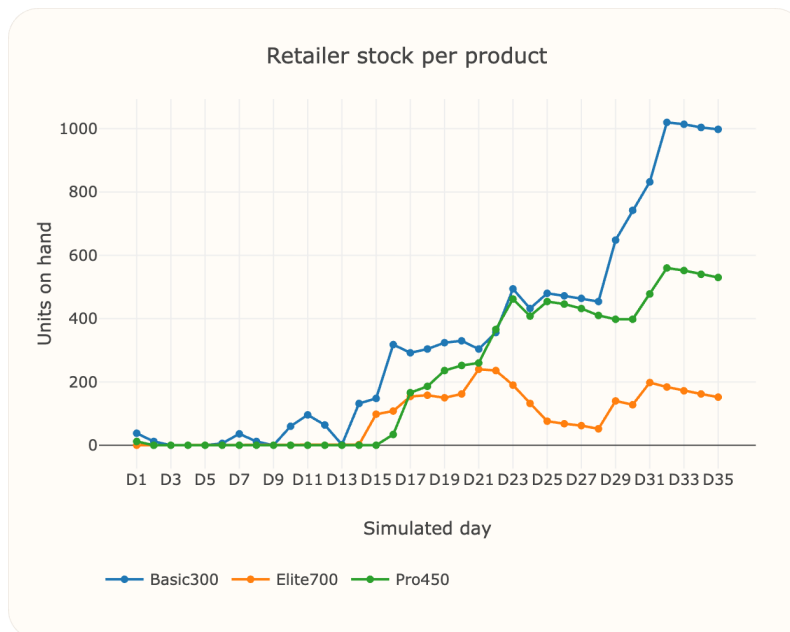


Figure 19: Retailer stock per printer model (Basic300 and Pro450)

- **Skill rewrites:** The week8 brief proposed a minimal five-section template. Key changes applied:
 1. **price list command removed:** the proposed template listed it under Available Commands, but the retailer CLI does not have this command. The agent was calling it and getting errors. Replaced with an explicit DO NOT rule.
 2. **Safety Stock Targets made explicit:** the proposal used a "stock < 3 days of recent average demand" formula to trigger reorders. This was replaced with fixed floor quantities (Basic300: 30 units, Pro450: 15 units, Elite700: 5 units) after the agent produced inconsistent reorder quantities by estimating daily demand differently on each turn.

3. **Reorder formula reworked:** the current skill uses the **Still Short** column from the state table ($\text{order_qty} = \text{still_short} + \text{safety_stock_target} - \text{already_inbound}$) and provides a daily demand baseline ($\approx 5/3/2$ for Basic300/Pro450/Elite700) so the agent does not have to estimate from history.
4. **Pricing model rebuilt:** the proposal had a simple $\pm 5\%$ rule based on whether stock was above or below a threshold. The current skill uses a two-layer model: first enforce the non-negotiable floor (retail $\geq \text{wholesale} \times 1.15$), then apply a demand-based adjustment table with seven conditions mapping **demand_modifier**, backorder count, and **price_sensitivity**: **high** to adjustment percentages (-8% to $+8\%$). The 30% default margin becomes a target rather than a floor, and demand signals override it. This change was driven by the agent raising prices too slowly during Black Friday and cutting them too slowly after the post-holiday lull.
5. **Markup floor corrected:** the proposal said “do not set retail below wholesale + 20%.” The actual CLI validation is $\text{wholesale} \times 1.15$ (15%). The skill was updated to match the real constraint and sets 30% as the default working target.

3 Simulation Results

Two scenarios were run: holiday-rush (35 days, volatile) and calm-market (35 days, baseline).

3.1 Scenario Definitions

Event	Days	demand_modifier	supply_modifier	lead_time_modifier
Normal	1–10	1.0	1.0	1.0
Black Friday	11–13	3.0	1.0	1.0
Chip shortage	14–20	1.5	0.4	2.0
Christmas rush	18–25	2.5	0.6	1.2
Post-holiday lull	26–35	0.5	1.0	1.0
Calm market	1–20	1.0	1.0	1.0

Days 18–20 have both chip shortage and Christmas active simultaneously. The engine multiplies demand modifiers ($1.5 \times 2.5 \rightarrow 3.75$ effective demand) and takes the minimum supply modifier (0.4), producing the most stressed window of the entire run.

3.2 Results & Interpretation

3.2.1 Did the manufacturer build stock ahead of Black Friday?

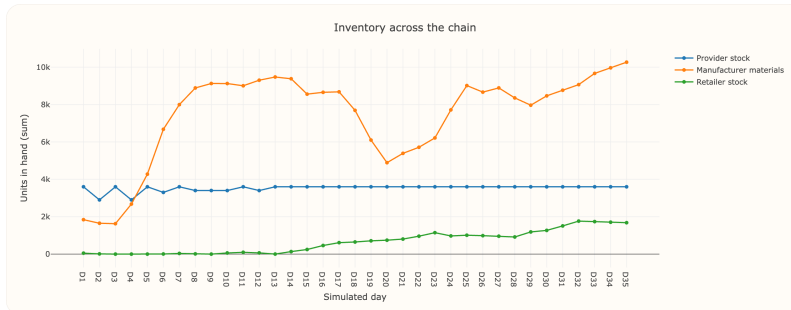


Figure 20: Total stock across all three tiers (chain-wide scale)

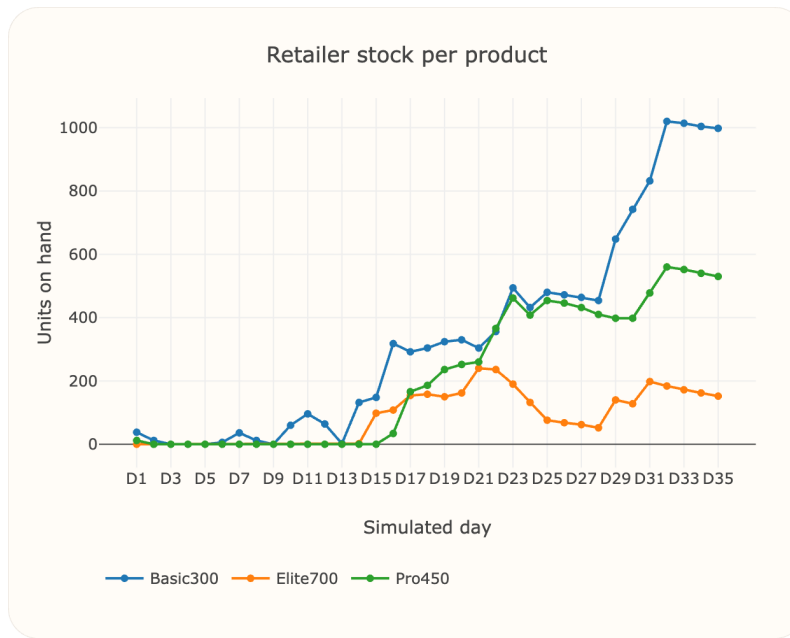


Figure 21: Individual printer counts

The retailer's printer stock rose from near zero on day 6 to 30 units on day 10 and 48 units on day 11, which is the first day of Black Friday. This build-up was driven by the manufacturer's production queue: active production orders grew from 7 on day 3 to 38 by day 10, showing the agent was releasing large batches well in advance. On the materials side, Control Board inventory climbed from 110 on day 2 to 1,742 by day 9, reflecting aggressive upstream ordering that the agent triggered because stock was below its floor. The manufacturer did not explicitly anticipate Black Friday (the market signal does not arrive in advance), but the proactive reordering rules in the skill produced the right behaviour anyway.

3.2.2 When stockouts happened, whose decision was the proximate cause?

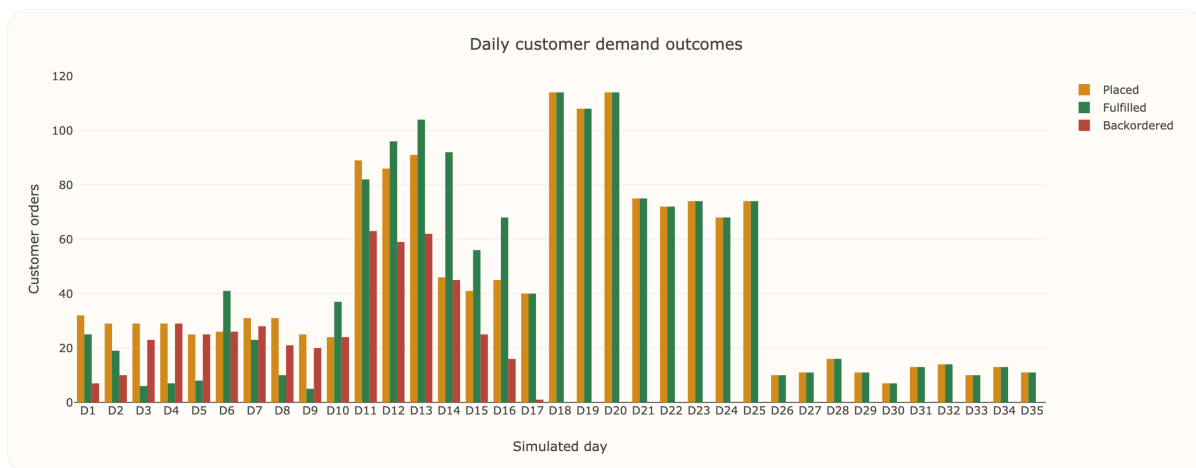


Figure 22: Daily customer demand outcomes

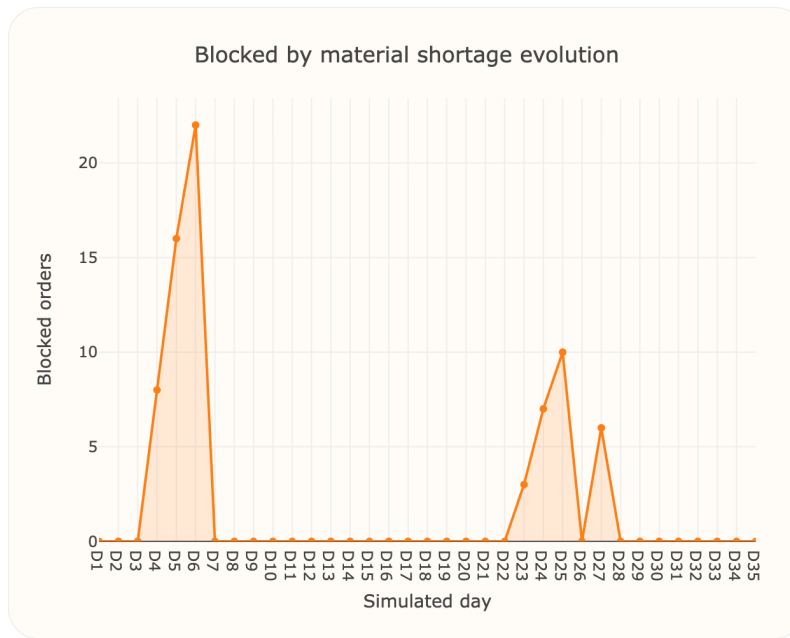


Figure 23: Blocked by material shortage evolution

The stockout on days 3–6 (four consecutive days at zero retailer stock) was a throughput bottleneck at the manufacturer rather than a materials shortage. By day 3 the manufacturer had 545 Control Boards in inventory, so materials were not the constraint, but blocked orders grew from 8 on day 4 to 22 on day 6, meaning the assembly queue had more work than it could complete per turn. The retailer was placing ~25 orders per day but printers were not arriving because the production pipeline needed several days to catch up after the initial stock depletion. Recovery came on day 6 when 41 units were fulfilled (clearing accumulated backorders), suggesting the manufacturer’s queued production orders finally cleared. The proximate cause was the retailer starting with only 25 units and immediately selling through them, with no same-day production possible.

Day	Retailer stock	Orders placed	Fulfilled	Backordered	Blocked (mfr)
1	25	32	25	7	0
2	6	29	19	10	0
3	0	29	6	23	0
4	0	29	7	29	8
5	0	25	8	25	16
6	3	26	41	26	22

3.2.3 Did prices stabilise or oscillate?

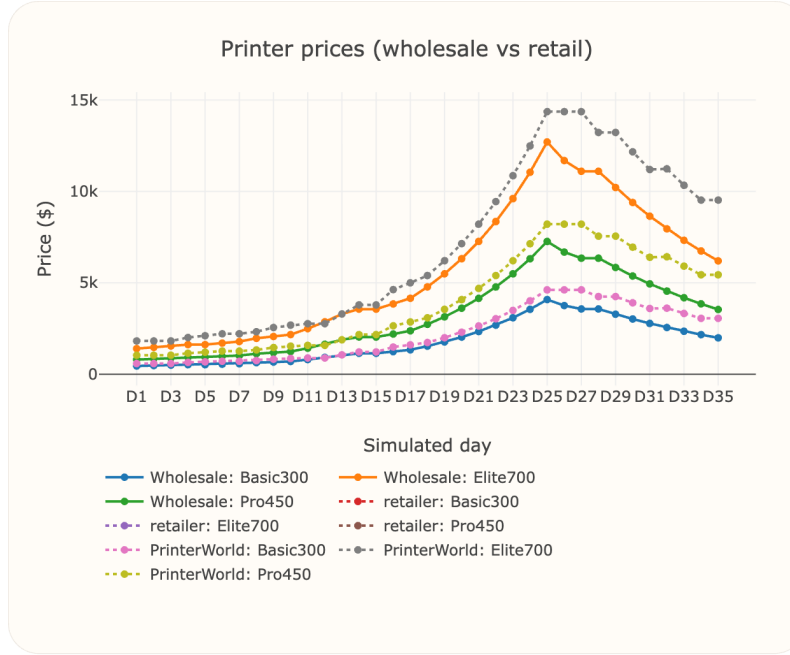


Figure 24: Printer prices

Both wholesale and retail prices moved monotonically with only 3 direction changes across the entire run without any oscillation. Basic300 wholesale rose steadily from 450 on day 1 to 4,082 on day 25 (the Christmas rush peak), then fell gradually to 1,990 by day 35. The retail price lagged slightly behind: it stayed at 585 for three days while wholesale had already risen, and held at 4,614 for three extra days into the post-holiday lull before catching up. The only genuine price swing was in the provider’s Control Board tier-1 price, which jumped from 55 to 220 on day 17 and back to 55 within three days — but this was the provider agent overcorrecting, and it did not cause the printer prices to oscillate because the manufacturer’s pricing rules smooth out single-day input cost spikes.

Day	Event	Basic300 wholesale	Basic300 retail	CB tier-1
1	normal	450	585	40
3	normal	496	585	55
10	normal	697	862	55
16	chip shortage	1,236	1,487	55
17	chip shortage	1,334	1,606	220
18	chip + christmas	1,535	1,735	110
20	chip + christmas	2,029	2,294	55
25	christmas peak	4,082	4,614	55
26	post-holiday lull	3,755	4,614	55
29	post-holiday lull	3,282	4,247	55
35	post-holiday lull	1,990	3,057	55

3.2.4 Can you identify a bullwhip moment?

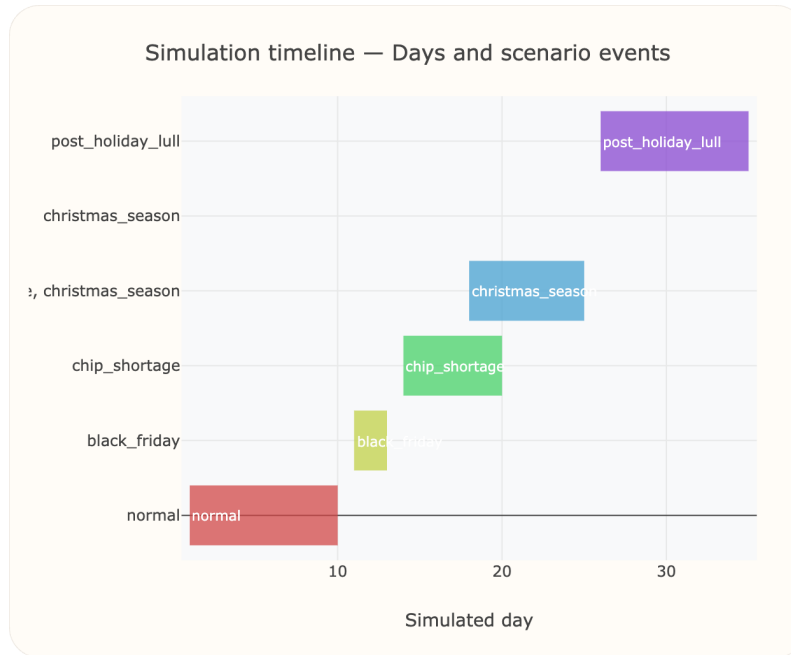


Figure 25: Active scenario events by day (demand and supply modifiers in effect)

There is no bullwhip moment in this run. Looking at the actual manufacturer-to-provider purchase orders, the manufacturer's ordering was driven by its own internal stock floor targets rather than by retail demand signals. The largest upstream orders (2,500–2,800 units/day) happened during days 1–4 when retail demand was only ~29/day, because the manufacturer was building its initial stock buffer. During Black Friday (days 11–13) when retail orders tripled to ~89/day, manufacturer orders to the provider stayed flat at 2,100–2,300 not showing any amplification. During the Christmas rush (days 18–25), manufacturer orders actually declined to 600–1,800/day because it was drawing down existing inventory instead of ordering more. The post-holiday overstock (retailer stock growing from 493 to 840 units after day 26) showed a pipeline inertia, which means that printers already in production kept arriving after demand collapsed, not a bullwhip amplification across tiers.

3.2.5 Financial performance

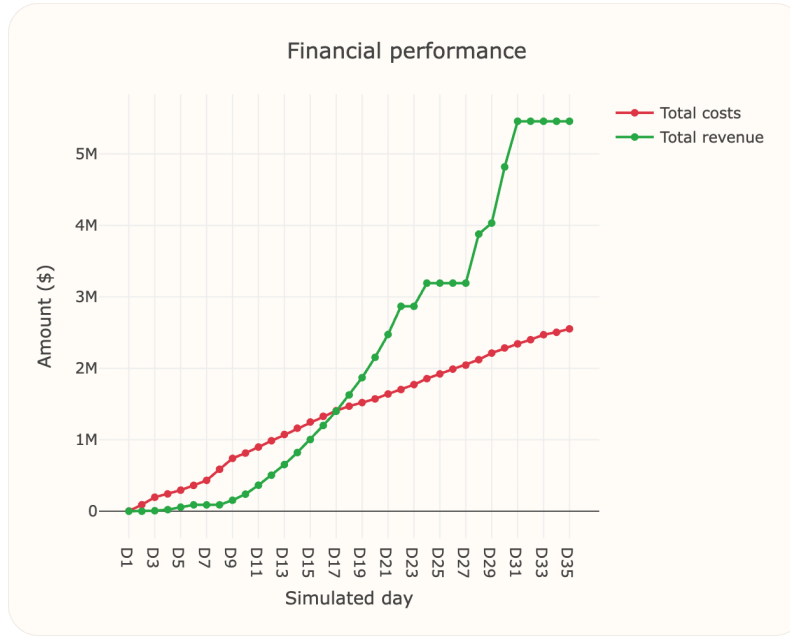


Figure 26: Financial performance

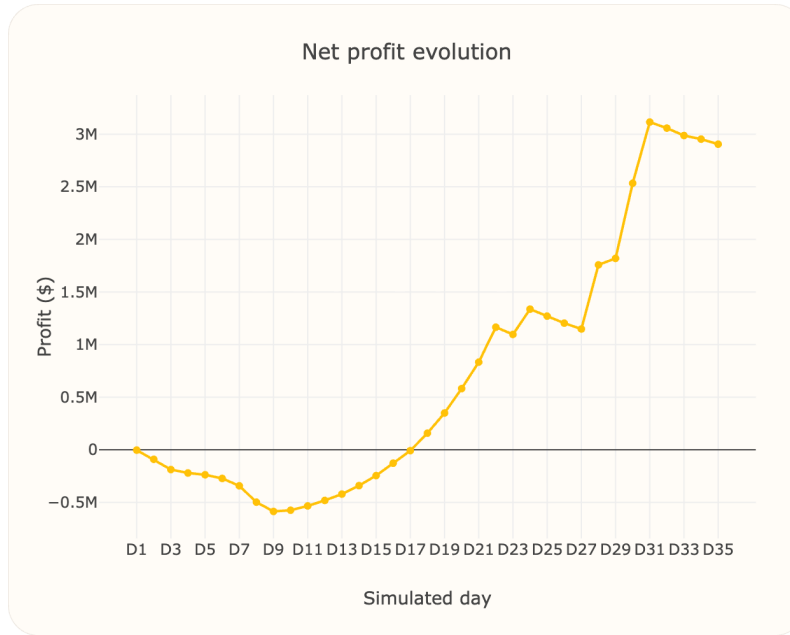


Figure 27: Net profit evolution

Costs increased in a very linear way throughout the run, as the fixed assembly line costs accrued every day regardless of output. Revenues, by contrast, were near zero until day 8, after which they grew steeply as finished printers started shipping to the retailer. The factory stopped running at a loss on day 17, when cumulative revenues finally surpassed cumulative costs. From day 31 onwards revenues stabilised as the post-holiday lull reduced demand and the manufacturer's production effectively stopped.

3.3 Scenario Comparison between Holiday Rush Scenario and Calm Market Scenario

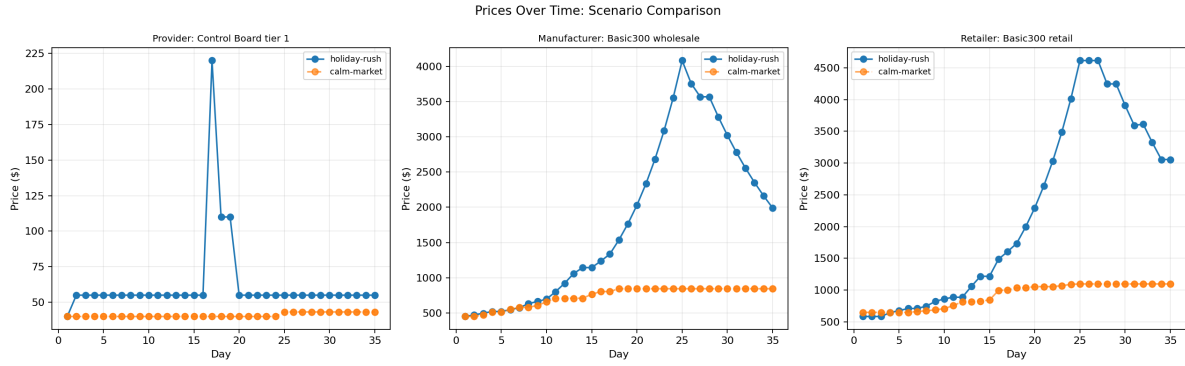


Figure 28: Printer prices: holiday-rush vs calm-market

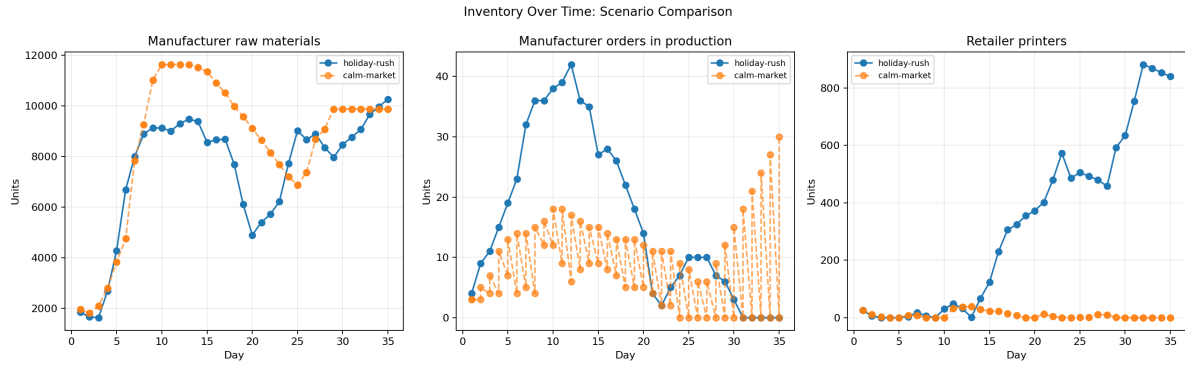


Figure 29: Retailer & manufacturer inventory: holiday-rush vs calm-market

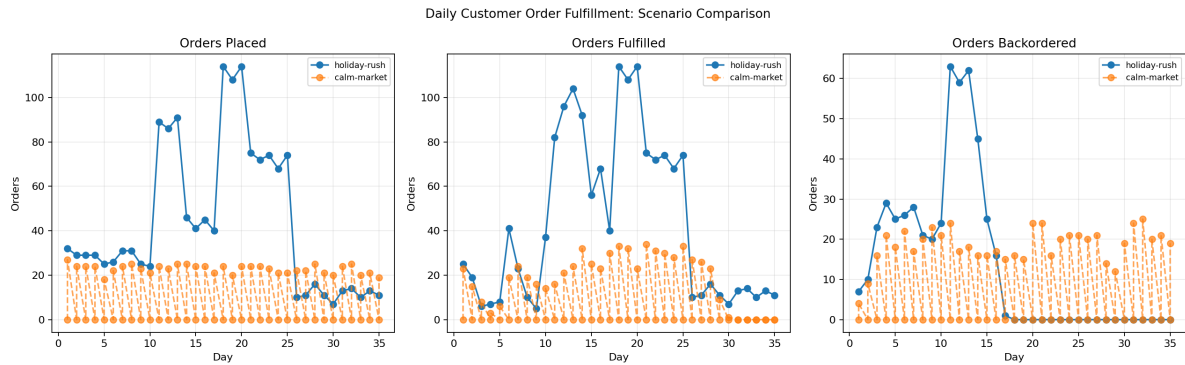


Figure 30: Order fulfillment: holiday-rush vs calm-market

- **Prices:** The holiday run produced a $9\times$ wholesale price swing ($450 \rightarrow 4,082 \rightarrow 1,990$) driven by the demand surges. The calm run barely moved, peaking at 844 on day 20, less than double the starting price.
- **Buffer-building:** In the holiday run, demand spikes triggered proactive inventory build-up; the retailer reached 48 printers ahead of Black Friday and 840 by the end. In the calm run, the retailer's stock never recovered from the day 3–10 stockout and stayed near zero for most of the simulation.
- **Backorders:** Counterintuitively, the volatile run produced fewer total backorders (484 vs 646), because the agents responded better to change than to a flat steady-state signal. The demand spikes prompted action that the calm signal did not.

- **Assembly lines:** Neither scenario triggered the manufacturer to open more than 2 lines, suggesting the scaling thresholds were conservative enough that a 35-day holiday surge did not cross them.
- **Failure modes:** Opposite outcomes from the same agents, the holiday run ended in post-holiday overstock with no mechanism to clear it; the calm run ended in chronic understocking with no mechanism to build up. Both are failures of adaptation, just in opposite directions.

3.4 Emergent Behaviour

The most surprising behaviour was “stress-induced perfect fulfillment” on days 18–20, the hardest window in the entire simulation. The chip shortage (`supply_modifier = 0.4`) and Christmas rush (`demand_modifier` up to 3.75 combined) overlapped simultaneously, yet those three days recorded 114/108/114 orders placed and 114/108/114 fulfilled: 100% fulfillment with zero backorders. Every other stressed period produced backorders. What happened is that the chip shortage had already forced the manufacturer to build up a large inventory buffer during days 14–17 (when demand was only 1.5×), and that buffer was exactly what the system needed when demand tripled. The agents did not plan this, they each followed their independent skill rules, but the timing of the two events created an accidental alignment between inventory peaks and demand peaks that neither a pure demand surge nor a pure supply shock would have produced alone.

A second emergent behaviour was model-dependent: the same skill file produced opposite outcomes depending on which LLM ran it. In the Gemini run on a calm-market scenario, the manufacturing agent opened 8 assembly lines despite zero backlog, zero demand surge, and no pending orders, burning \$13,600/day with zero output and finishing at −\$859,397 net loss. The Claude/Haiku run on the identical skill file stayed at 2 lines throughout. The instruction was ambiguous enough that Gemini misread it; Claude followed it correctly. This was not a bug in the skill file in any absolute sense, it was an emergent property of how different models interpret the same natural-language instruction differently, and the only way to discover it was to run the full simulation with each model.

4 Vibe-Coding Reflection

4.1 How we used Claude Code

Claude Code was used at different layers in Week 8: it wrote the turn engine scaffolding, generated the initial skill files, and was then used iteratively to refine those skills as failure modes appeared in logs. Week 8 prompts were observation-driven (“the agent wrote this in the log, why is it wrong and how do we fix the skill?”). Claude Code was also used to generate graphs from `metrics.jsonl`.

4.2 What worked

The same pattern that worked in Week 6 held in Week 8: precise, file-scoped prompts with explicit PRD section references produced correct code on the first attempt. Asking Claude Code to implement a named function in a named file, with numbered acceptance criteria, eliminated most ambiguity.

The skill files themselves benefited from an iterative loop: run one day in isolation, read the log, identify a bad decision, tighten the skill, repeat.

4.3 What did not work

Skill ambiguities cannot be caught by reading the file, they only surface when the simulation runs and the agent logs its own reasoning. The clearest example was the “empty queue means no capacity” misreading: the manufacturing skill said to check the queue before releasing orders, which looks correct on paper, but the agent read an empty queue as “nothing to produce” rather than “the factory is idle, release now.” This caused it to sit idle on days 6 and 8 with pending orders it could have filled. A related gap was the missing downscaling rule: the skill had clear instructions for opening assembly lines but none for closing them, so the agent kept paying fixed line costs through the final days of the run despite producing nothing and the retailer already holding 840 printers in stock.

4.4 The one thing we would redesign

The sequential turn order (provider, then manufacturer, then retailer) is the single design decision we would change. Each agent acts on yesterday’s state and can never react to the same-day decisions of the agents that went before it:

the manufacturer ships to the retailer before the retailer has placed that day's demand, and the provider confirms delivery before the manufacturer has processed it. This lag is what produced the days 3–6 stockout cascade: even though the manufacturer had stock on day 3, the retailer's replenishment order placed on day 2 could not be fulfilled until the next turn. A synchronous round model, where all three agents propose actions, then a resolver applies them in a single atomic step, would eliminate the one-day propagation delay and more accurately reflect how a real supply chain negotiates the same business day.

A System Architecture Diagram

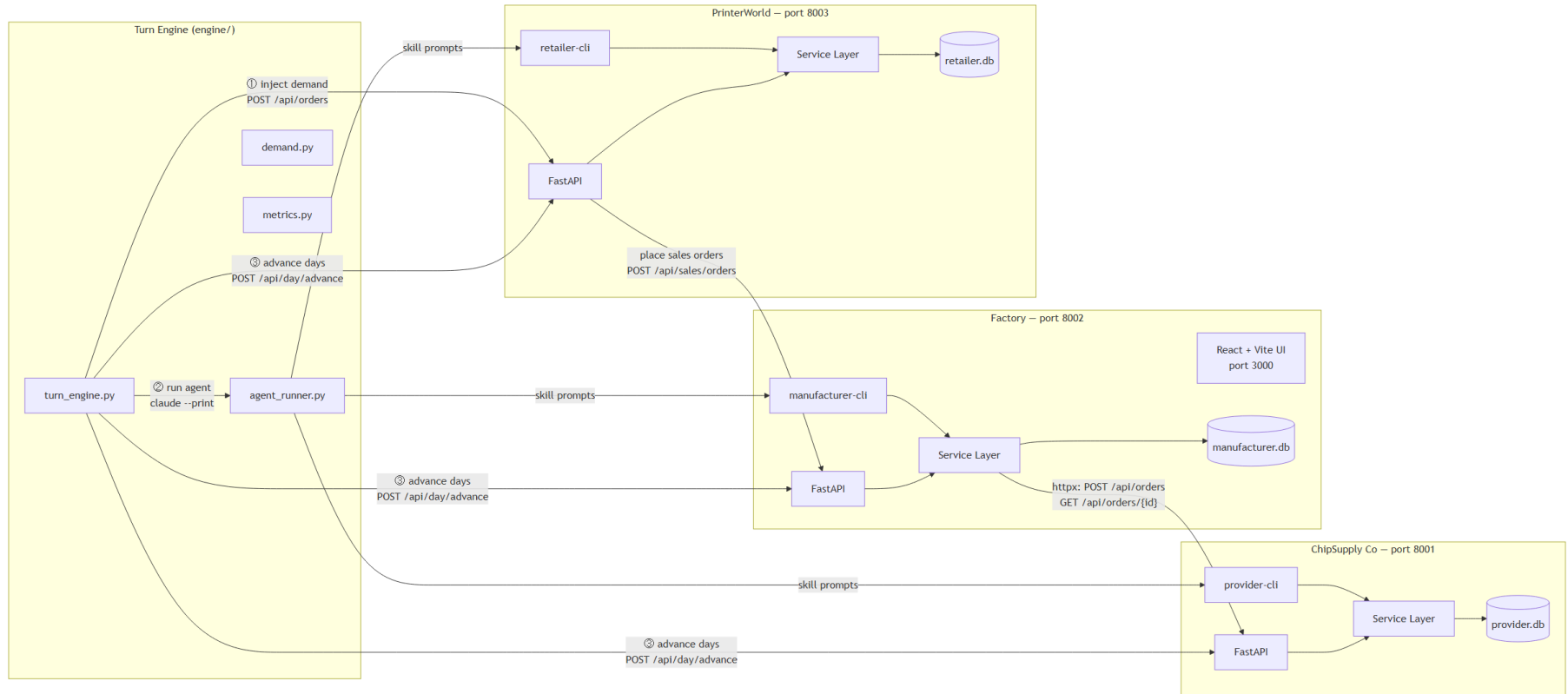


Figure 31: Full system architecture: Turn Engine, Provider (ChipSupply Co), Manufacturer (Factory), and Retailer (PrinterWorld).